Instagram template design brief

Kelpcrete / Reading Room / SD Projects

Please create a consistent set of Instagram templates using broad colour panels, strong typography and full-width photographs, as shown in the mockups. There should be no border around the image. Supply layered Photoshop templates for posts and Reel overlays, structured for a future ChatGPT plugin to populate.

Format and composition

- Use broad solid-colour panels alongside full-width or full-bleed photography. Build versions for a type-led poster, a photo with a colour panel, and a full-bleed photograph. Keep the panel proportions and spacing consistent.
- Use underlined, sentence-case sans-serif headings and smaller serif supporting text. Titles are optional. Source Sans is a provisional starting point; propose the exact family, weights and serif pairing.
- Include a rounded category capsule with one of these labels: Kelpcrete, Reading Room or SD Projects. The intended position is top right. The mockups show it on the left, which is not final; keep its position editable for review.
- Use our own photographs, artwork and wording for finished posts. Allow optional supporting text, dates and locations, with a clear hierarchy and a consistent position for small details.
- Include an optional logo layer using supplied brand assets. Show examples with and without a logo, and make the layout work when titles, supporting text or logos are hidden.

Colour palette

We need to work with colours we are already using, especially the teal used for Reading Room and on the website, black, and RAL 5002 blue. We could also explore a purple and find a suitable colour for Kelpcrete.

Colour	Direction
Existing teal	Use the Reading Room and website teal. Confirm its exact brand colour code.
Black	Include in the palette and test for text and background treatments.
RAL 5002 blue	Use this existing blue reference. Confirm the approved digital sRGB value.
Possible purple	Explore as an option; no shade or category assignment agreed yet.
Kelpcrete colour	Propose a suitable colour within the palette; still to be decided.

Show the colours together and on actual layouts before fixing the category combinations. The colours in the mockups are illustrative, not the approved palette. Record agreed HEX and RGB values in sRGB.

Talk it through

I’m around all of tomorrow, Thursday 5 November 2026, so we can check in and talk it through. We can review the colours, typography, panel proportions and capsule placement together.

Illustrative mockups

These mockups show the intended panel-and-photo format, underlined headings, supporting text and category labels. The text, images, dates and locations are fictional examples, not real project information.



Examples use white type. The teal and RAL 5002 blue shown are provisional digital approximations. Kelpcrete's proposed fluorescent orange, #FF6A00, is also provisional. White on orange needs a legibility check, particularly for small text; test a black backing or darker overlay if needed. Capsules are shown on the left; final placement is still to be reviewed.

What to develop from these

- Keep the broad colour panel and edge-to-edge photograph, with no border around the image. Refine the proportions so both short and longer content work well.
- Replace the illustrative colours with the existing brand palette described on the previous page, plus the purple and Kelpcrete options we agree.
- Show a top-right capsule variation and optional logo treatments. Keep titles, underlines, supporting text, dates, capsules, panels and photographs independently editable.

Reference: Adobe Source Sans 3

Instagram sizes and Reel overlays

Prepare the same visual system at the working sizes below. These are design canvases, not a promise that every Instagram publishing route accepts every format. Keep the 4:5 version as a practical feed fallback.

Template ID	Ratio	Canvas in pixels	Use
feed_portrait	4:5	1080 × 1350	Main portrait post and carousel option
feed_tall	3:4	1080 × 1440	Tall photo option; test the intended publishing route
feed_square	1:1	1080 × 1080	Square post and carousel option
feed_landscape	≈ 1.91:1	1080 × 566	Wide photograph option
reel_overlay	9:16	1080 × 1920	Full-height overlay and Reel cover master

Use one consistent canvas ratio for each carousel set. Recompose each layout rather than stretching a finished design. Keep extra image coverage in the smart object so crops can be adjusted without distorting the photograph.

Reels and safe placement

- Keep the video full-bleed with no border. Adapt the text and colour-panel format for overlays, with unused areas transparent. Keep panels, capsule, title and optional logo on separate editable layers.
- For Reels, place the capsule at the top right of the usable content area, inset from the app interface. It does not need to sit in the physical corner of the video.
- Add hidden guides for the top interface, bottom caption area and right-hand controls. Keep titles, category text, logos and important image details away from them.
- Provide a separate cover composition or crop preview. Check the full Reel, feed preview and profile-grid preview; a single edge-aligned layout may not survive all crops.

Safe-zone note: the interface varies by placement, device, caption length and paid versus organic use. Agree a conservative working guide, then check it in the actual Instagram preview. Do not treat one set of pixel margins as a universal guarantee.

Overlay exports

Supply transparent PNG overlays at 1080 × 1920 for each theme, with title-on and title-off examples and logo-on and logo-off examples. PNG exports are static; the PSD retains editable text and shapes. If animation is later wanted, agree the editing app and an alpha-enabled video format separately.

Composite overlays into the final Reel in the video editor and export the finished video as MP4 with H.264, using the intended publishing route’s current settings. A transparent overlay PNG is not a finished Reel.

Reference: Meta Reels publishing specification | Instagram photo resolution | Meta safe-zone guidance

Checked 4 November 2026. Meta’s public API reference confirms 9:16 as the recommended Reel ratio. Instagram photo and Meta safe-zone help pages could not be fully retrieved; confirm current app, ad and API limits before final delivery.

PSD structure and handoff

Use RGB, 8-bit documents with an embedded sRGB profile. Build one master PSD per canvas size with named theme variants or layer comps. Keep equivalent layers in the same structure across every master. Pixel dimensions govern output; do not rely on a DPI label.

Stable layer name	Editable construction
GUIDES	Hidden group for safe areas, margins and crop previews; never export
LOGO	Optional embedded smart object; hidden by default
CATEGORY_TEXT	Live text containing the approved category label
CATEGORY_SHAPE	Editable vector capsule with a separate colour setting
TITLE_TEXT TITLE_UNDERLINE	Live title text with defined bounds and a separate editable underline
SUPPORT_TEXT DATE_TEXT	Optional live supporting text and date, each independently editable
COLOUR_PANEL	Editable solid-colour vector panel; never a border around the image
IMAGE	Embedded smart object with a non-destructive crop or mask
BACKGROUND	Separate background; hidden for transparent Reel overlays

Preparing for the ChatGPT plugin

The plugin should choose a layout, theme and size, replace content and toggle the logo. Agree its PSD rendering or automation method before claiming compatibility. A working PSD integration is not assumed by this brief.

Include a template map with template_id, version, dimensions, layout, theme, title, supporting_text, date, image, image_focal_point and show_logo. Map each field to stable layer names or layer comps. Record fonts, colour values, text bounds, crop rules and export settings.

Define title line limits and a minimum font size. Flag overflow for review. Hide empty text and its underline together. Embed or package assets so there are no missing-file dependencies.

Files to supply and checks

- Layered PSD masters, the style sheet and template map, font source and licence details, supplied logo assets, and brief replacement/export instructions.
- One finished example per theme, previews of each ratio, and transparent Reel overlay PNGs. Use names such as kelpcrete_feed_portrait_v01.psd and reading_room_reel_overlay_v01.png.
- Export feed images as high-quality sRGB JPEGs; retain PNG versions where useful for sharp graphics or the chosen workflow. Never flatten the only editable master.
- Test short, long and empty titles, all three category labels, bright and dark images, different image crops, and logo on/off. Confirm clean transparency and no exported guides.
- Run one sample through the agreed plugin renderer and check the result in Instagram before considering the templates ready for repeat use.

Still to confirm: exact brand teal and digital blue values, purple and Kelpcrete options, fonts, layout proportions, capsule placement, logo assets and the plugin’s rendering method.